

CHINA MUSINGS

Capturing Alpha in HK IPOs

Hong Kong's initial public offering (IPO) market has experienced a powerful resurgence, with more than 60 new listings making their debut ytd. Newly listed companies have delivered strong post-IPO performance, +45%/49%/67% on average in the first trading day/first month/three months post-listing, although with significant performance dispersion. We highlight 3 strategies to trade for alpha in this market.

- 1. Factors driving post-IPO returns:** Standalone, large-cap listings consistently outperform small-caps and dual-listed peers. High retail oversubscription serves as a primary catalyst for short-term price appreciation, while moderate cornerstone ownership of 30% to 50% signals high-quality listings positioned for sustainable outperformance. Over extended horizons exceeding 3 months, structural outperformance is concentrated in high-growth New Economy sectors.
- 2. Lock-Up Expiration Risks:** The HK market may see US\$274bn of potential new supply from shares due to post-IPO lock-up expiration. Historical precedents indicate a moderate price decline of 4% to 7% within three to six months post-release accompanied by high return dispersion. Near-term post-expiration performance is primarily determined by the volume of released lock-up shares relative to outstanding shares. Conversely, medium-term returns are structurally driven by the post-release free float ratio and the stock's pre-expiration performance.
- 3. Tactical Trading via Index and Southbound Inclusion:** The selling pressure associated with expiring lock-up periods can be softened by index and Southbound inclusion. Eligible newly listed Hong Kong IPOs can qualify for fast-track inclusion in MSCI and Hang Seng indices, driving meaningful passive inflows. Furthermore, primary listings meeting specific criteria can gain access to deep mainland liquidity via the Southbound Connect.

We construct three watchlists for investors: 1) newly listed companies with potential to deliver robust post-IPO returns per historical patterns, 2) stocks facing significant upcoming lock-up expirations, and 3) candidates that could qualify for Southbound Stock Connect inclusion.

Si Fu, Ph.D.
+852-2978-0200 | si.fu@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C.

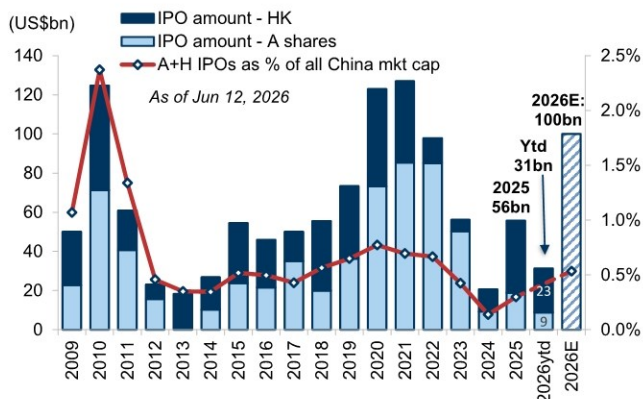
Kinger Lau, CFA
+852-2978-1224 | kinger.lau@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C.

Timothy Moe, CFA
+65-6889-1199 | timothy.moe@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Singapore) Pte

Kevin Wang, CFA
+852-2978-2446 | kevin.wang@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C.

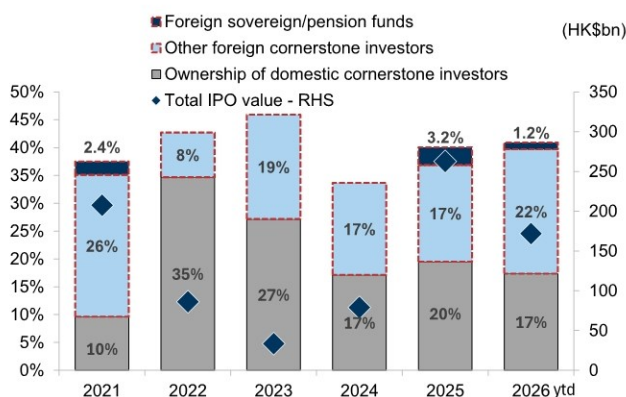
Review of 2025-26 IPOs

Exhibit 1: Fund-raising activity recovered in 2025 and we expect it to further normalize to historical averages in 2026



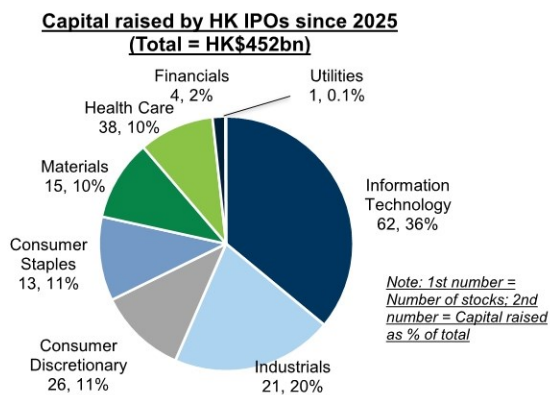
Source: Wind, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: Cornerstone investors contributed around 40% of capital raised by HK IPOs



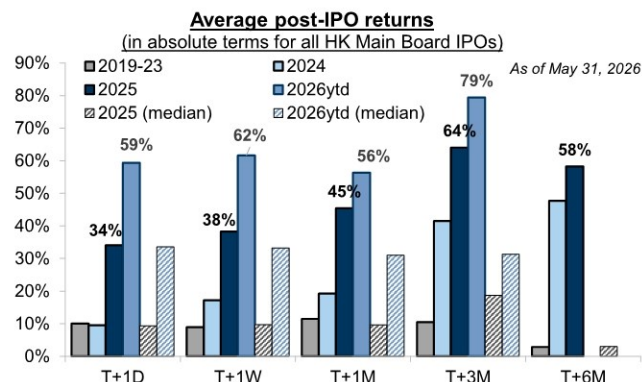
Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: IT, Industrials, and Consumer Discretionary are the top 3 sectors that raised the most capital in HK



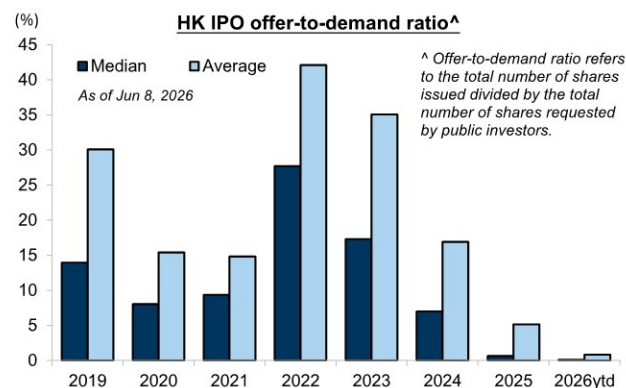
Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Investors participating in IPOs over the past two years could have achieved approximately 50% returns on average in the first month



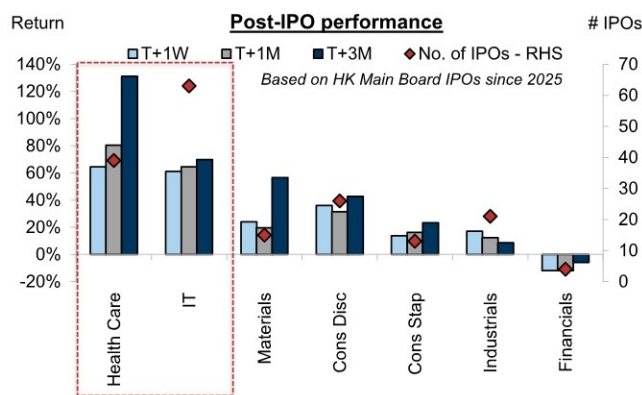
Source: Wind, FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: The offer-to-demand ratio for HK IPOs this year dropped to a historical low, which indicates strong retail investor demand



Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: Biotech and AI companies tend to have stronger post-IPO performance



Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Factors impacting post-IPO performance

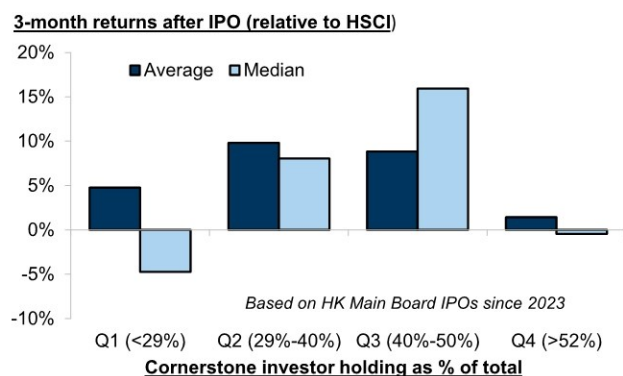
Hong Kong IPOs throughout **the 2025-26 cycle have demonstrated remarkably post-listing performance**. On average, newly listed companies since 2025 delivered a 45% return on their first trading day, expanding to 49% in the first month, and reaching 67% within three months post-listing.

However, post-IPO **performance dispersion remains high**, characterized by extreme outliers; the top-performing stock rallied more than tenfold within six months of its IPO, whereas the worst-performing one declined by 74%. A granular analysis of issuer characteristics reveals several key structural drivers of these return differentials:

- **Market Capitalization and Listing Type:** Large-cap listings tend to generate superior post-IPO returns, whereas dual-listed companies underperform compared to those executing a fresh, standalone listing in Hong Kong.
- **Cornerstone Backing:** A moderate cornerstone shareholder ownership, specifically within the 30% to 50% range, serves as an indicator of potential long-term outperformance. However, excessive concentration that severely restricts the tradable free float can negatively impact post-IPO liquidity and performance.
- **Retail Demand:** Stocks exhibiting high oversubscription ratios tend to demonstrate stronger price appreciation, particularly during the first week of trading. Nonetheless, these impacts are typically short-lived and tend to fade as initial momentum dissipates.
- **Growth vs. Valuation:** Issuers in New Economy sectors exhibiting higher growth potential tend to yield greater returns. Companies with high revenue growth, even before making profits, tend to be favored and outperform the low growth stocks in traditional sectors. Crucially, entry valuation does not appear to be a primary determinant of post-listing performance.

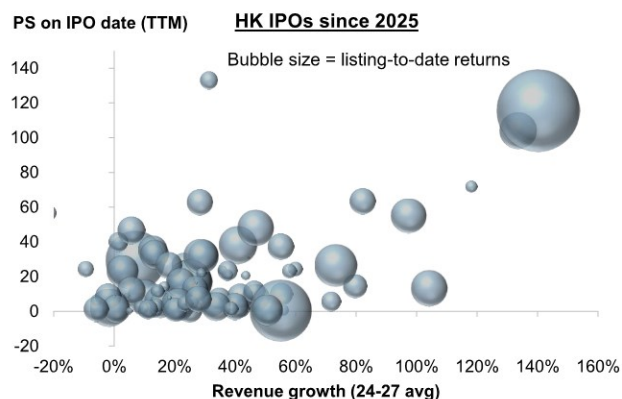
Spillover effects to sector peers: [Our previous analysis](#) indicated that sectors with new listings in Hong Kong typically see their peers in the same sector modestly outperform the market in the following week. We examine all HK Main Board IPO cases since 2024, and find, for the key fields with more IPOs, such as Health Care and IT, the whole sector tends to outperform the market in the week following the IPO. Similarly, **following the large US IPOs**, Chinese stocks in the same sector tend to outperform in the subsequent week as well. This post-listing momentum suggests that investor focus often shifts toward broader industry developments and fundamental synergies between domestic firms and their newly listed global peers.

Exhibit 7: Companies where cornerstone investors acquire 30-50% of shares generally demonstrate stronger post-IPO performance



Source: Wind, FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

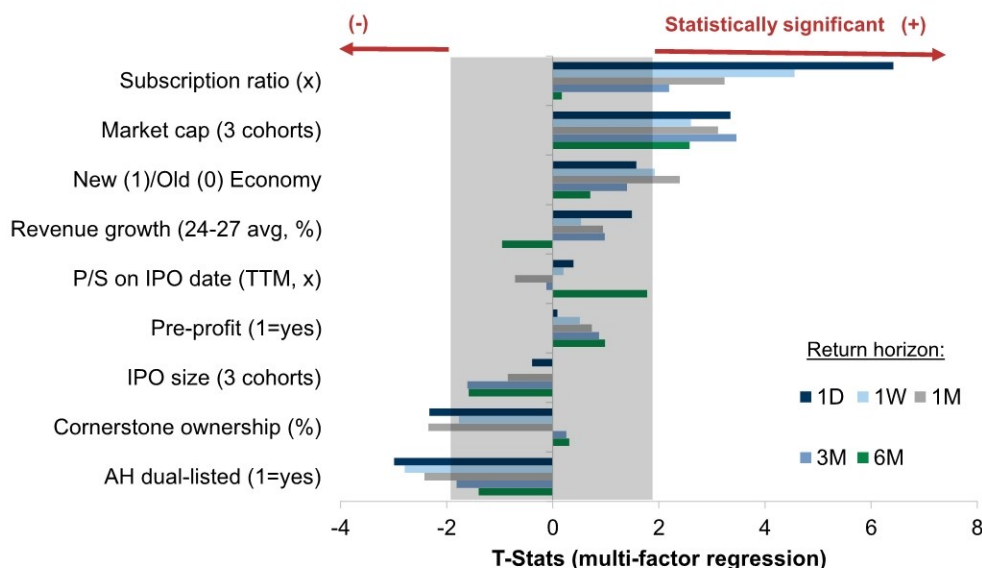
Exhibit 8: Despite higher valuations, newly listed companies with significant growth potential tend to perform better after their IPOs



Source: Wind, FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 9: Large caps with standalone listings in Hong Kong and high over-subscription ratios tend to generate superior post-IPO returns

Factors driving post-IPO relative returns of HK new listings since Sep 2024



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

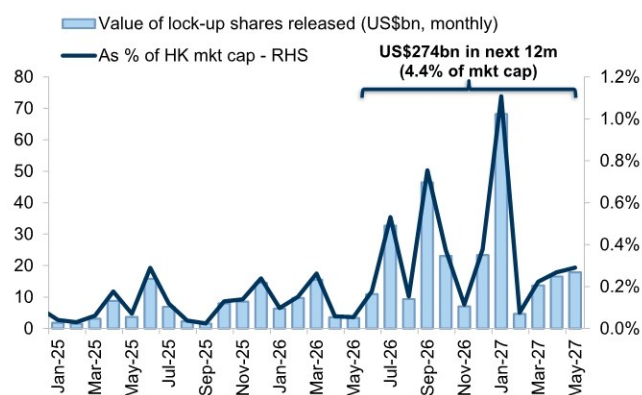
Performance around lockup expiry

With the resurgence of Hong Kong IPO activity, **an estimated \$274 billion of lock-up shares are projected to be released into the Hong Kong market over the next 12 months**, following the expiration of typical six-month lock-up periods. This represents an unprecedented, record-high volume of lock-up expiration, driven primarily by low initial public float ratios (new issuance as a percentage of total shares) coupled with exceptionally strong post-IPO returns. However, this potential post-lockup supply may not fully materialize if pre-IPO investors and insiders choose to maintain their equity positions.

Despite substantial capital demands arising from new listings, post-IPO secondary financing, and lock-up expiration, **we anticipate that robust equity demand could be able to absorb this incoming supply**. We estimate that total demand for Hong Kong-listed equities could exceed US\$400bn. This demand is supported by US\$180bn in corporate distributions (comprising dividends and share buybacks), US\$20–30bn in capital reallocation from global long-term institutional investors, US\$200bn potential Southbound capital inflows, and additional buying interest from retail investors.

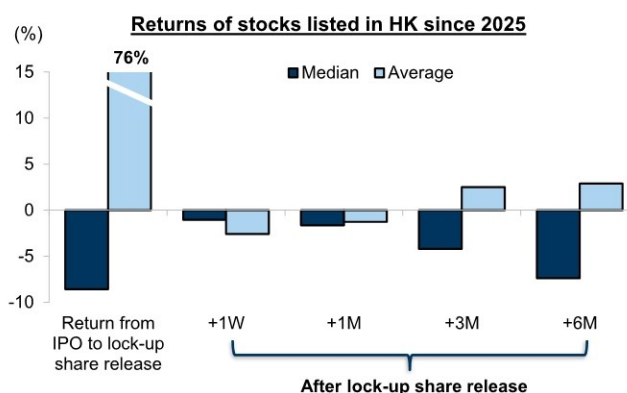
Historical precedents suggest that **equities typically experience moderate downward price pressure following lock-up expiration**, with a median share price decline of 4% in three months and 7% in six months post-release; however, performance exhibits significant divergence across individual issuers. We examined factors that may influence stock performance after lock-up share release. In the near term, the volume of lock-up shares released as a percentage of total outstanding shares serves as the primary determinant of performance (specifically within the first week post-expiration). Conversely, the post-release free float ratio and the stock's pre-expiration post-IPO performance are the key structural drivers of medium-term returns to the following three- and six-month returns. Companies with high cornerstone ownership, especially domestic ones, tend to observe higher selling pressure after lock-up share release.

Exhibit 10: US\$274bn of lock-up shares are expected to release to the HK markets in coming 12 months



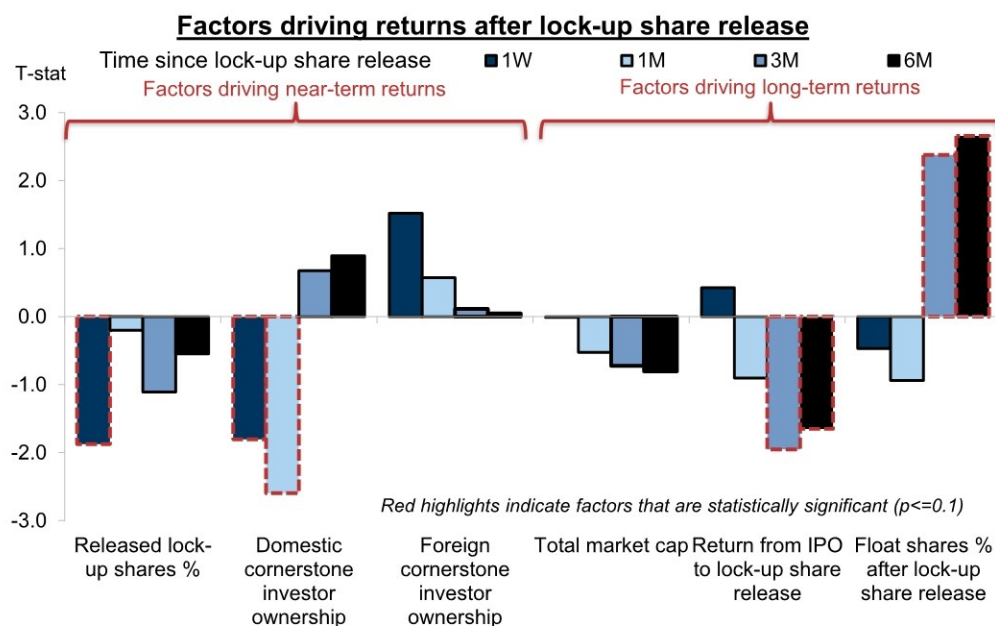
Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 11: Equities typically experience moderate downward price pressure following lock-up expirations



Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 12: The percentage of shares released serves as the primary determinant of the first week post-expiration returns, while the post-release free float ratio and the stock's pre-expiration post-IPO performance are the key drivers of medium-term returns



Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Southbound and index inclusion

Newly listed stocks could qualify for global benchmarks and the Southbound Stock Connect upon satisfying specific listing history, market capitalization, and liquidity thresholds. Under the index methodologies established by MSCI and the Hang Seng Indexes Company, new listings meeting stringent market capitalization and liquidity criteria are eligible for fast-track index inclusion, requiring a minimum listing history of just 10 trading days. We estimate that approximately US\$134bn in passive assets under management (AUM) currently tracks various MSCI benchmark indices that incorporate Chinese equities. Within the Hang Seng index suite, the flagship Hang Seng Index (HSI) and the Hang Seng TECH Index (HSTECH) command the largest passive investor bases, with \$28 billion and \$24 billion in tracking AUM, respectively. Consequently, potential index inclusion serves as a catalyst, driving passive capital inflows that structurally support post-listing stock performance.

Inclusion in the Southbound Stock Connect program provides Hong Kong-listed companies with direct access to vast onshore mainland liquidity. While secondary listings are generally excluded from Southbound eligibility, primary Hong Kong listings that satisfy specific market capitalization and liquidity requirements can be seamlessly integrated into this investable universe. Historical data indicates that Southbound buying momentum typically persists for several months following a stock's inclusion, providing sustained price support for the underlying shares. Our historical analysis indicates that Southbound ownership typically increases by 1pp within the first two days of inclusion, expanding to 5 pp over the subsequent three months. HK new listings since 2025 have attracted US\$10bn cumulative Southbound net buying. This dual demand from passive index-tracking funds and Southbound investors establishes a vital liquidity

buffer, effectively mitigating the selling pressure associated with expiring lock-up periods. The ongoing expansion of the Southbound universe via new IPOs will continue to offer mainland investors highly diversified opportunities to optimize their portfolios.

Exhibit 13: Large caps could be eligible for fast-track index inclusion to key benchmarks

Index Summary					
	MSCI China	HSI	HSCEI	HSTECH	HSCI
Current Index Cap (US\$bn)	2,804	2,004	1,433	458	3,334
6M ADVT (US\$bn)	118	11.8	11.0	7.8	19.5
# of constituents	579	90	50	30	531
HK shares	163	90	50	30	531
Passive Tracking AUM (US\$bn)	157	29.5	4.8	47.8	-
as % of current index cap	5.6%	1.5%	0.3%	10.4%	-
Fast-track index inclusion					
Criteria	Mkt cap > 1.8x cutoff level; and freefloat market cap > 1.8x 1/2 of cutoff level				
	No fast-track rule; 3 month listing history				
	Top 10				
	Top 10				
	Top 10% of the existing HSCI constituents				
Timing	After the 10th trading day				
	Next quarterly rebalancing after listing for 3-6 months				
	After the 10th trading day				
	After the 10th trading day				
	After the 10th trading day				

Note: Data is as of April 16, 2026.

Source: HSIL, FactSet, EPFR, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

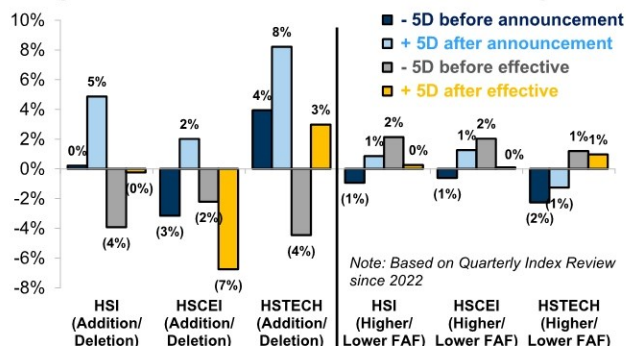
Exhibit 15: Primary Hong Kong listings that satisfy specific market capitalization and liquidity requirements can be added into Southbound universe

Southbound inclusion criteria	
AH Dual-listed Companies:	Automatically included after the price-stabilization period (typically 1 month post-IPO).
Non-AH Dual-listed Companies:	Included after being added to HSCI, with market cap > HK\$5bn
WVR ("W") Companies:	
	Included during the March/September HSCI semi-annual review window
	7 months (6 months + 20 trading days) post-IPO
	Average daily turnover > US\$6mn
	Average listed market cap ≥ US\$2.6bn (HK\$20bn)
	Or inclusion in HSCI Mid-Cap.

Source: HKEX, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

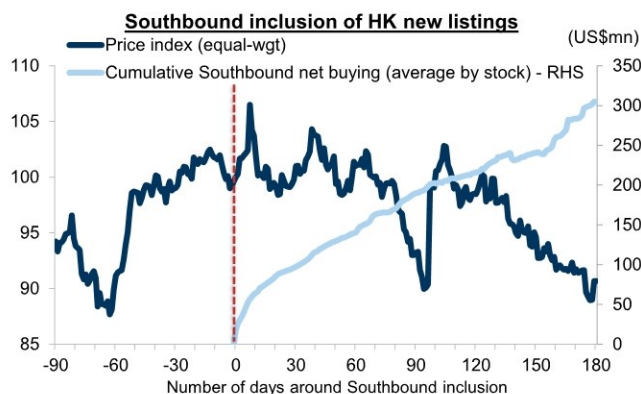
Exhibit 14: Additions/deletions in HSI and HSTECH experienced stronger price actions compared to those in HSCEI

Average relative returns around historical HS indexes rebalancing



Source: FactSet, MSCI, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 16: Newly-listed stocks tend to have a short-lived rally after Southbound inclusion, while inflows tend to persist



Source: Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Watchlists for post-IPO outperforms, lock-up share expiry and Southbound inclusion

Following trading strategies across three critical horizons as we identify in previous sections—post-IPO performance, lock-up share expiration, and index or Southbound Stock Connect inclusion—we screen for high-potential stocks that warrant investor attention. First, we screen for year-to-date, large-cap listings characterized by robust revenue growth (>20%) and moderate cornerstone ownership (30–50%), as these attributes typically signal a higher probability of sustainable post-IPO outperformance. Second, we identify stocks with significant lock-up expirations (>30% of total shares outstanding) scheduled over the next 12 months, which may trigger technical selling pressure—particularly for names that have generated extraordinary post-IPO returns. Third, we target companies listed within the past year whose market capitalizations exceed the Southbound Stock Connect inclusion threshold (HK\$5bn) but have not yet

been added, offering investors a tactical opportunity to capitalize on potential inclusion events that drive capital inflows. For newly listed companies exhibiting robust fundamentals, investors may adopt a hold strategy during the initial post-IPO phase, closely monitor upcoming lock-up expiry windows, and systematically increase exposure once the majority of shares become free float and accessible via the Southbound Stock Connect.

Exhibit 17: We screen for new HK listings ytd with features that could lead to sustainable post-IPO outperformance

Ticker	Name	GICS Sector	30-50%		>20%	>US\$1bn		
			Cornerstone ownership	IPO subscription ratio (x)	Revenue growth (24-27 avg)	Quoted Price (HKD)	Listed Mkt Cap (US\$bn)	ADVT (US\$mn)
9903 HK	Iluvatar CoreX Semiconductor	IT	43%	414	97%	531	16.6	53
100 HK	MiniMax Group	IT	49%	459	162%	435	12.9	196
1768 HK	Busy Ming	Consumer Staples	36%	1899	42%	380	10.5	19
6656 HK	Sigenergy Technology	IT	50%	1102	310%	375	6.8	45
3277 HK	Gpixel Changchun Microelectronics	IT	50%	1138	30%	87	3.3	37
1236 HK	Shenzhen LDRobot	IT	32%	6708	60%	43	1.8	8
3310 HK	Viewtrix Technology	IT	35%	3560	24%	33	1.8	12
2675 HK	Edge Medical	Health Care	49%	1092	118%	40	1.7	4
1609 HK	Star Sports Medicine	Health Care	35%	7823	23%	194	1.4	6
3388 HK	Shenzhen Creality 3D Technology	Industrials	50%	3829	37%	23	1.4	20
1779 HK	LongBio Pharma	Health Care	50%	4763	100%	142	1.3	20
1021 HK	Huayan Robotics	Industrials	49%	1265	36%	19	1.3	8
600 HK	Axera Semiconductor	IT	48%	105	68%	17	1.3	6
Average			44%	2628	85%	-	4.8	33

Note: Prices as of Jun 12, 2026; Valuations are based on IBES consensus forecasts.

Source: Wind, FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 18: We screen for stocks with a high portion of lock-up shares to expire in the next 12 months that could face potential selling pressure

Ticker	Name	GICS Sector	>30%	>50%	>US\$1bn		
			Lock-up shares to release in next 12m as % of total	Post-IPO returns	Quoted Price (HKD)	Listed Mkt Cap (US\$bn)	ADVT (US\$mn)
2513 HK	Knowledge Atlas Technology	IT	46%	844%	1061	30.0	209
9903 HK	Iluvatar CoreX Semiconductor	IT	91%	265%	531	16.6	53
100 HK	MiniMax	IT	67%	140%	435	12.9	196
1768 HK	Busy Ming	Cons Stap	94%	59%	380	10.5	19
6082 HK	Biren Technology	IT	42%	155%	52	7.9	54
6651 HK	51WORLD Digital Twin Tech	IT	82%	284%	114	5.8	60
2476 HK	Victory Giant Technology	IT	34%	80%	379	5.3	268
3317 HK	Xunce Technology	IT	78%	207%	154	5.2	81
3858 HK	Jiaxin Int'l Resources	Materials	61%	712%	87	5.1	55
2788 HK	Chuangxin Industries	Materials	72%	81%	19	5.0	23
1879 HK	Xizhi Technology	IT	56%	156%	480	4.7	87
2526 HK	Diagens Biotechnology	Health Care	91%	229%	318	3.6	9
6809 HK	Montage Technology	IT	43%	232%	365	3.5	128
2718 HK	Mininglamp Technology	IT	86%	74%	202	3.4	7
3277 HK	Gpixel Changchun Microelectronics	IT	42%	126%	87	3.3	37
2706 HK	Haizhi Technology	IT	94%	106%	64	3.3	24
68 HK	Manycore Tech	IT	93%	92%	15	3.2	70
6810 HK	Sunmi Technology	IT	68%	206%	83	3.2	8
3986 HK	GigaDevice Semiconductor	IT	43%	303%	687	2.9	117
2723 HK	DeepZero Technology	Comm Svcs	90%	352%	237	2.7	32
2670 HK	Yunji Technology	Industrials	78%	210%	308	2.5	1
2889 HK	Pateo Connect Technology	Cons Disc	41%	114%	210	2.1	12
1384 HK	Deepexi Technology	IT	90%	84%	49	2.1	54
1236 HK	Shenzhen LDRobot	IT	93%	62%	43	1.8	8
2637 HK	Haixi Pharmaceuticals	Health Care	85%	105%	179	1.8	6
3310 HK	Viewtrix Technology	IT	92%	53%	33	1.8	12
2632 HK	New Vision Automotive Electronics	Cons Disc	77%	179%	125	1.7	2
901 HK	SDMC Technology	IT	91%	86%	61	1.6	7
6872 HK	TenNor Therapeutics	Health Care	78%	246%	242	1.6	7
2729 HK	Galaxis Technology	Industrials	91%	71%	28	1.5	4
3625 HK	FourSemi Semiconductor	IT	88%	163%	102	1.4	5
1511 HK	UISEE Technologies	Industrials	72%	53%	88	1.4	9
2553 HK	Shougang LanzaTech Technology	Energy	57%	189%	41	1.4	35
9887 HK	Nanjing Leads Biolabs	Health Care	56%	54%	56	1.4	7
6636 HK	Extreme Vision Technology	IT	90%	132%	97	1.4	11
1609 HK	Star Sports Medicine	Health Care	90%	97%	194	1.4	6
7630 HK	IMPACT Therapeutics	Health Care	90%	81%	37	1.3	7
2617 HK	TransThera Sciences	Health Care	70%	144%	33	1.3	19
3200 HK	Han's CNC Technology	Industrials	44%	61%	152	1.1	31
2687 HK	Able Digital Science&Tech	Cons Disc	83%	103%	135	1.1	3
Average			73%	175%	-	4.3	45

Note: Prices as of Jun 12, 2026; Valuations are based on IBES consensus forecasts.

Source: Wind, FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 19: We screen for newly listed HK stocks with potential for Southbound inclusion

>HK\$5bn

Ticker	Name	GICS Sector	Quoted Price (HKD)	Mkt Cap (HK\$bn, security)	ADVT (US\$mn)
100 HK	MiniMax Group	IT	435	92.1	196
6656 HK	Sigenergy Technology	Industrials	375	53.8	45
1879 HK	Xizhi Technology	IT	480	36.0	87
2526 HK	Diagens Biotechnology	Health Care	318	28.9	9
3277 HK	Gpixel Changchun Microelectronics	IT	87	27.2	37
68 HK	Manycore Tech	IT	15	25.2	70
2723 HK	DeepZero Technology	Comm Svcs	237	22.8	32
6810 HK	Sunmi Technology	IT	83	22.7	8
2670 HK	Yunji Technology	Industrials	308	18.5	1
3355 HK	FS.com	IT	34	14.5	6
7666 HK	Metis TechBio	Health Care	13	14.3	25
1236 HK	LDRobot	IT	43	14.3	8
3310 HK	Viewtrix Technology	IT	33	13.6	12
6872 HK	TenNor Therapeutics	Health Care	242	13.6	7
2632 HK	New Vision Automotive Electronics	Cons Disc	125	13.4	2
2726 HK	Epiworld International	IT	112	13.3	4
901 HK	SDMC Technology	IT	61	12.8	7
7688 HK	Top Numerical Control Technology	Industrials	35	12.4	25
2729 HK	Galaxis Technology	Industrials	28	12.2	4
1511 HK	UISEE Technologies	Industrials	88	11.7	9
3625 HK	FourSemi Semiconductor	IT	102	11.6	5
2553 HK	Shougang LanzaTech Technology	Energy	41	11.3	35
6887 HK	Sunshine Lake Pharma	Health Care	34	11.1	2
1609 HK	Star Sports Medicine	Health Care	194	10.6	6
3388 HK	Creality 3D Technology	Industrials	23	10.6	20
1779 HK	LongBio Pharma	Health Care	142	10.5	20
6636 HK	Extreme Vision Technology	IT	97	10.4	11
7630 HK	IMPACT Therapeutics	Health Care	37	10.3	7
1021 HK	Huayan Robotics	Industrials	19	10.2	8
600 HK	Axera Semiconductor	IT	17	9.5	6
6938 HK	Ribo Life Science	Health Care	50	8.7	4
3887 HK	HashKey Holdings	Financials	3	8.3	2
6871 HK	Robotphoenix Intelligent Tech	Industrials	23	7.3	13
1081 HK	Dajin Heavy Industry	Industrials	60	6.4	46
Average			-	17.9	23

Note: Prices as of Jun 12, 2026; Valuations are based on IBES consensus forecasts.

Source: SZSE, FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Si Fu, Ph.D., Kinger Lau, CFA, Timothy Moe, CFA and Kevin Wang, CFA, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views, which have not been influenced by considerations of the firm's business or client relationships.

Unless otherwise stated, the individuals listed on the cover page of this report are analysts in Goldman Sachs' Global Investment Research division.

Contributing Authors: Si Fu, Ph.D. Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C., Kinger Lau, CFA Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C., Timothy Moe, CFA Goldman Sachs (Singapore) Pte, Kevin Wang, CFA Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C..

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